



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION  
UNION PANAFRICAINE DES ETUDIANTS  
UNIÃO DOS ESTUDANTES DE TODA A ÁFRICA  
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## Report on The International Day of the Girl 2024

**THEME:** "Girls' Vision For The Future: Better Prospects In TVET"

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## 1.0 Foreword

AASU is deeply committed to championing equal educational opportunities, empowering African youth, and driving inclusivity across all areas of learning and professional growth. TVET offers immense potential for youth empowerment, and today we focus on ensuring that girls can harness these opportunities and thrive in technical fields.

On International Day of the Girl 2024, we joined the Ghana Education Service (GES), Girls Education Unit (GEU) and organizing partners to organize the International Day of the Girl 2024. This year's event occurred at the Ada Technical Institute, celebrating the theme "Girls' Vision for the Future: Better Prospects in TVET." This event underscores not only the transformative power of girls and young women in Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) but also reaffirms what we, at the All-Africa Students Union (AASU), stand for.

Together with partners like UNICEF, CAMFED, FAWE, and the British Council, we aim to build a future where gender stereotypes no longer limit aspirations, where mentorship is accessible, and where policies actively promote gender equity. This event's dynamic cultural performances, inspiring poetry recitals, and insightful panel discussions remind us of the energy and promise young women bring to reshaping Africa's future.

As we reflect today, we are reminded of our responsibility to create environments that nurture the ambitions of every girl and young woman across the continent. By doing so, we drive forward the vision of an inclusive, educated, and empowered Africa led by the brilliance and determination of its youth.



Peter Kwasi Kodjie  
Secretary-General  
All-Africa Students Union (AASU)



## 2.0 Introduction

The International Day of the Girl 2024 event, held on the 11th of October at Ada Technical Institute, provided a platform to celebrate and support the role of girls in advancing Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET). The event organized under the theme "Girls' Vision for the Future: Better Prospects in TVET," brought together senior high and technical school students from the Ada enclave to be imparted and encouraged to take their TVET studies seriously.



Key invited guests representatives from UNICEF, CAMFED, FAWE, the British Council, GES - GEU staff and management, teachers and the Member of Parliament for the constituency, delivering speeches that highlighted the essential role of mentorship, gender equality, and pathways for women in technical disciplines. AASU joined the ceremony with 25 members.

The program featured a mix of cultural performances, poetry recitals, and a thought-provoking panel discussion, each designed to foster an environment of inspiration and insight. Participants and speakers explored vital themes such as the potential of girls in shaping the future workforce, the need to overcome gender-based barriers, and strategies to dismantle stereotypes in traditionally male-dominated fields. Through these dynamic exchanges, the event emphasized the importance of equipping girls with the skills and resources they need to thrive in TVET, underscoring the collective efforts required to build an inclusive and equitable future for all.

## 3.0 Event Details

### 3.1 Float

The event commenced with a float led by GES–GTNET and senior high school students from through the streets of Ada. On converging at the program grounds a Christian opening prayer was held by the Ada Technical School Chaplain.

### 3.2 Keynotes Speeches



There were speeches by the Chairperson in the person of the representative of the Queen Mother, Director-General, Ghana TVET Service ( Madam Nana Ama Mensah), Director-General, Ghana Education Service (Madam Gifty Asiedu) and solidarity remarks from the partner organizations that is from UNICEF-Ghana presented by Christopher Nkrumah-Education Specialist and Mrs Rhoda Enchil a Programme Officer , FAWE by Richard Amoani - National Coordinator ,CAMFED by Diana Lugutuah-Senior Programmes Officer and British Council by Gabriel Quashie.

Director Nana Ama delivered a welcome address, emphasizing the importance of TVET in empowering girls for a better future. She encouraged participants to “seize the opportunities TVET offers, especially in a world where technology is constantly evolving.”

Madam Gifty Asiedu, Director-General of the Girls Education Unit - GES, emphasized the need to challenge barriers hindering girls’ active participation in TVET, stating, “When girls are given the tools to succeed, they can design and build just like their male counterparts.”



The Member of Parliament for the constituency, Hon. Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe gave an inspiring speech about self-belief and the importance of Entrepreneurship. She mentioned that she will be leading a project that will donate 100 industrial sewing machines to young women and urge leaders to prioritize TVET education for both girls and boys. She says “Believe in yourself, the world is yours to shape!”



Bismark Amefianu Kudoafor and Belinda Mensah, the Chief Technical Officer and the Programmes Officer Environment and Climate Action working group respectfully delivered the solidarity speech on behalf of the Secretary-General, Mr. Peter Kwasi Kodjie of AASU. They shared AASU's commitment to advocating for equal opportunities for African Students and the numerous projects and programs organized to advance girls involvement in TVET. They reaffirmed their commitment to the cause.



### 3.2.2 Key Takeaways from Speeches

- **TVET as Empowerment:** Madam Nana Ama Mensah stressed TVET's role in equipping girls for future careers, urging them to seize evolving opportunities.
- **Gender Equality in TVET:** Madam Gifty Asiedu highlighted dismantling barriers in TVET, affirming that girls can succeed equally when given the right tools.
- **Entrepreneurship and Self-Belief:** Hon. Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe promoted self-belief and entrepreneurship, announcing a project to donate 100 sewing machines to young women.
- **AASUs Commitment to Equal Opportunities:** AASU representatives affirmed their dedication to promoting girls' involvement in TVET across Africa.
- **Partner Organization Support:** UNICEF-Ghana, FAWE, CAMFED, and the British Council pledged ongoing support for girls in TVET and equal opportunity initiatives



### 3.3 Cultural performances

Cultural performances and poetry recital display by Gorm D/A Basic School highlighted the need for more inclusive environments in TVET. It projected the prospects in TVET and the re-entry programs of Ghana Education Service. It also reviewed the talents of the basic school pupil.

### 3.4 Panel Discussion

A panel discussion moderated by Miss Hilda Bekoe, Programmes Officer Migration and Mobility at the AASU and Engr. Gladys Perpetual Awudi- Engineer and Lecturer, Koforidua Technical University, Diana Mawuena Ahiaku Engineer, Zhongmei, Engineering Group, Rhoda Sikanku Dzidedi, Teacher and Erica Abanam Electrical Engineering Student. The panel discussion captured the strides of the professionals. The students had the opportunity to ask questions and get their questions answered. The event was brought to an end with a Muslim prayer after the panel discussion.

#### 3.4.1 Key Takeaways from the Panel Discussions

- Students were empowered to take up courses in TVET.
- Practical lessons in the Technical field should make up the great part of TVET coursework
- Parents should be sensitized on the need to enroll their ward in TVET.
- Increased training equipments

## 4.0 Outcomes and Impact

The event was a significant platform for empowering girls in TVET, showcasing the role they play in shaping a future with better educational and employment prospects. Through the events, AASU established partnerships with

- The Girls Education Unit - GES
- Reiterated our commitment to girls' Education

## 5.0 Suggestions for future events

The event was a significant platform for empowering girls in TVET, showcasing the role they play in shaping a future with better educational and employment prospects. Through the events, AASU established partnerships with

- Future events could benefit from more interactive, hands-on demonstrations of TVET-related skills. Practical workshops could allow participants to engage directly with the tools and technologies being promoted.
- Follow-up actions required: There should be continued collaboration with partners like CAMFED, UNICEF, and the British Council to further promote TVET education for girls and break down the barriers that hinder their participation.

## 6.0 Conclusion

The International Day of the Girl 2024 event was an inspiring celebration of the potential and power of girls in TVET. The speeches, performances, and discussions highlighted the importance of breaking gender stereotypes, providing mentorship, and creating equal opportunities in education and employment for girls. The event underscored the critical role of organizations like CAMFED and UNICEF in supporting girls' education, particularly in TVET, and encouraged participants to continue working towards a future where girls can thrive in all sectors.





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